

THEN &amp; NOW

# THE 20TH-CENTURY STADIUM VS. THE CONNECTED ARENA

THE SCALE IS THE SAME. THE GUEST'S EXPECTATIONS HAVE BECOME FUNDAMENTALLY DIFFERENT.

## THE CLASSIC STADIUM — 20TH CENTURY

BUILT FOR CAPACITY, NOT EXPERIENCE

- **Paper tickets and box offices:** purchase friction was assumed — long lines were part of the ritual
- **Cash-only concessions:** limited menu, fixed stands, peak-hour gridlock was universal and accepted
- **One-tier seating:** general admission or assigned — premium was a velvet rope, not an experience layer
- **No post-event relationship:** the night ended at the parking lot — there was no follow-up, no capture, no loop
- **Friction as tradition:** "that's just how it goes" was the acceptable standard — alternatives didn't exist
- **Revenue ceiling:** gate revenue + F&B + merchandise — limited by physical throughput and no personalization

AND THE CROWD was the event. Everything else was infrastructure.



## THE CONNECTED ARENA — TODAY

BUILT FOR THE GUEST JOURNEY END-TO-END

- **Mobile-first ticketing:** purchase to entry in one tap — the expectation is zero friction from screen to gate
- **Mobile ordering + in-seat delivery:** F&B captured during the action, not sacrificed for it — wait time converted to revenue
- **Tiered experience layers:** general, club, suite, VIP — each tier priced and delivered as a distinct, complete experience
- **Post-event capture:** push notifications, highlight recaps, renewal offers — the relationship continues after the final buzzer
- **Friction as competitive liability:** guests now have alternatives — the couch, streaming, or the other venue across town
- **Revenue beyond the gate:** data, personalization, and pre/post-event commerce multiply the value of each attendance

AND THE CROWD IS the product. The event is the occasion.

*The gap between these two columns is where the modern venue operator either wins the next decade or loses it.*